

Why the U.S. Might Make Your Morning OJ More Expensive

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Imagine waking up and your favorite orange juice costs more. That could happen because the U.S. government wants to add a 25% **tariff** a kind of tax on things we buy from Brazil. President Trump's trade team says Brazil isn't playing fair. They point to problems like cutting down too many trees in the Amazon **rainforest** and rules that make it harder for American companies to sell **digital** stuff there. The U.S. Trade Rep, Jamieson Greer, announced the plan on Monday. He says an investigation found Brazil's trade practices "are unreasonable and burden or restrict US **commerce**." That's a fancy way of saying they hurt American businesses. But here's a twist: the U.S. actually sells more to Brazil than it buys! In March, we sold \$3.3 billion in goods to them and only bought \$2.9 billion. That's a \$420 million **surplus** for us. Not everything would get the new tax. Beef, coffee, **rare earths** (special metals used in phones), and airplane parts are safe. The old 50% **tariff** from last year which partly punished Brazil for going after Trump's friend, former President Bolsonaro would drop to 25% on many items. You can have a say! Starting Thursday, anyone can send comments to the government. The deadline is July 1, and there's a public hearing on July 6. So if you care about the price of your breakfast, speak up!

Word Treasure

tariff -- A tariff is a tax a government puts on goods coming from another country to make them more expensive.

rainforest -- A rainforest is a thick, wet forest with lots of trees and rain, like the Amazon.

surplus -- A surplus is extra money left over when a country sells more to another country than it buys.

rare earths -- Rare earths are special metals used inside phones, computers, and other high-tech devices.

digital -- Digital means anything on computers, the internet, or electronic screens rather than on paper.

commerce -- Commerce is all the buying and selling of goods and services between people and countries.

Background you need

President Donald Trump (the U.S. president since 2025) has often used tariffs as a tool in trade fights, believing they protect American jobs.

Jamieson Greer is the U.S. Trade Representative, the official who speaks for America's trade policies and handles disagreements with other countries.

The Amazon rainforest is the largest tropical forest in the world, and many worry that cutting it down hurts the environment and animals that live there.

Break it down

WHO: President Trump's trade team, U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer, and American consumers

WHAT: A new 25% tariff proposed on many imports from Brazil, which could raise prices on items like orange juice

WHERE: Between the United States and Brazil

WHY: Because the U.S. government says Brazil's trade practices are unreasonable and restrict American commerce

Why it matters

If the price of orange juice and other Brazil-sourced products goes up, your family might pay more at the grocery store, affecting your breakfast choices.

Test what you remember

1. What does the U.S. government want to put on Brazilian goods?
 - (A) A 25% tariff
 - (B) A 50% tax
 - (C) A ban on all products
 - (D) A discount
2. Who announced the plan to add tariffs on Brazil?
 - (A) President Trump
 - (B) Jamieson Greer
 - (C) Former President Bolsonaro
 - (D) The governor of Brazil
3. Which item is NOT going to get the new tax under the plan?
 - (A) Orange juice
 - (B) Coffee
 - (C) Shoes
 - (D) Lumber
4. What is the trade surplus the U.S. had with Brazil in March?
 - (A) \$420 million
 - (B) \$3.3 billion
 - (C) \$2.9 billion
 - (D) \$25 million
5. When is the deadline for people to send comments about the tariff plan?
 - (A) July 1
 - (B) July 6
 - (C) Monday
 - (D) Thursday
6. Why does the U.S. say Brazil is not playing fair?
 - (A) Brazil sells too many cars
 - (B) Brazil cuts down trees and makes it hard for U.S. digital companies
 - (C) Brazil doesn't buy any American products
 - (D) Brazil puts a 100% tax on U.S. goods

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: B 4: A 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

- 1. U.S. government view (positive):** American officials argue the tariff will pressure Brazil to stop unfair trade habits and protect U.S. businesses from losing out.
- 2. Consumer and Brazilian view (negative):** Many shoppers and Brazilian exporters worry prices will climb, making everyday things less affordable and hurting Brazilian companies.
- 3. Trade pattern view (neutral):** The fact that the U.S. already sells more to Brazil than it buys makes this tariff unusual, since it targets a country where America has an advantage.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):